

Yandel Polanco

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yandel.dev | Chapel Hill, NC & Miami, Florida

EDUCATION

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Bachelors of Science in Computer Science — GPA: 4.0

Chapel Hill, NC
August 2026 – May 2028

Miami Dade College: Honors College

Associate of Arts in Computer Science — GPA: 3.8

Miami, FL
August 2024 – May 2026

EXPERIENCE

ROBLOX

Game Developer

Feb. 2023 – Present

Remote

- Developed core gameplay mechanics in Lua with a team of 10 developers for a ROBLOX game with 300 million total visits.
- Improved game stability and player retention by identifying and fixing outage-causing bugs using crash reports.
- Composed original game music to enhance player experience, evaluated through play-testing and player feedback.

Nexus Horizon

Lead Software Engineer

Sep. 2025 – May 2026

Miami, FL

- Developed software for autonomous warehouse robotics to automate material handling with a cost-effective, scalable solution.
- Built robotic control systems with ROS2, Python, C++, and Arduino for navigation, sensor integration, and device communication.
- Designed and tested electronic prototypes through breadboarding, wiring, and microcontroller integration to validate hardware-software interactions.
- Selected for an accelerator program and won a startup competition; pitched the product at eMerge Americas.

INIT

President

Aug. 2024 – May 2026

Miami, FL

- Developed technical workshops, networking events, and engagement initiatives, increasing chapter membership by 27 from an initial 5 members.
- Secured \$30,000+ in external funding to sustain chapter operations and events.

Hackathon Program Manager

- Led planning and execution of the SharkByte Hackathon with a 12-member organizing team, delivering a 36-hour event with 200+ attendees and 49 completed projects.
- Secured \$25,000+ in chapter funding and in-kind support through partnerships with Microsoft, Cybriant, Red Bull, React Miami, and Miami Dade College to fund SharkByte.

Miami Dade College (MDC)

Student Researcher

Feb. 2025 – Aug. 2025

Remote

- Built a full-stack AI-powered literary analysis application using Flask, Python, HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.
- Implemented authentication, database connectivity, and file uploads for secure user interactions and document management.
- Integrated machine learning models to analyze novels and short stories through scalable backend processing pipelines.

Outamation

Artificial Intelligence Extern

Feb. 2025 – March 2025

Remote

- Classified, extracted, and analyzed mortgage documents and resumes in Google Colab using Python, Fitz, Tesseract OCR, PIL, and JSON to process and structure document data.

PROJECTS

Velocity

Lead Developer, Music Composer & 3D Artist

- Led development of a fast-paced movement FPS in Unity using C# and Visual Studio, collaborating with programmers and coordinating tasks and deadlines through project management software.
- Created 3D assets in Blender and composed an original soundtrack in FL Studio.
- Presented the game to a panel of judges with decades of game-development experience.

Portfolio Website | HTML, CSS, JavaScript

yandel.dev

- Built a personal portfolio website using vanilla HTML, CSS, and JavaScript to showcase projects.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, C#, C++, HTML/CSS

Frameworks/Libraries: Flask, NumPy, Hugging Face, LayoutLM

AI/ML: Meta Llama API, Tesseract OCR

Developer Tools: Git, GitHub, PostgreSQL, ROS2, Unity, Blender, Arduino IDE, Visual Studio, FL Studio